

The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2021

Round 2



Solution and marking.

Scoring: (max 39)

- **Q.4.1.** 1 point for each correct number. (max 19)
- **Q.4.2.** 1 point for each correct word. (max 9)
- **Q.4.3.** Assign points as indicated in the explanation (max 20)

Q.4.1.

A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S
6	15	9	5	2	10	3	4	12	1	16	13	8	18	14	19	11	17	7

Q.4.2.

Hmong	English
lub hnuv	the sun
txoj hlua	the rope
zaj nkauj	the song
sau ntawv	the essay
daim teb	the field
lub txiv hmab	the grape

Q.4.3.

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Commentary

Each of the Hmong phrases is composed of two parts: a classifier followed by a noun. [2]

The classifiers in the problem are as follows: (max 14)

daim [1]	flat things [1]
kua [1]	liquids [1]
lub [1]	round things / general [1]
phau [1]	piles, stacks [1]
tsab [1]	letters, written things [1]
txoj [1]	long things [1]
zaj [1]	spoken [1]

Some nouns refer to only one thing (at least in the problem) e.g. **kev** means only road. Others, such as **mis** represent a broader concept, taking on different meanings depending on the classifier. [2]

Nouns can be combined to give compound nouns, where the first noun is the head/the word modified/the main word; the resulting compound then combines with an appropriate classifier. [2]

Here is a list of the pairings of Hmong and English phrases.

Hmong	English
daim nplooj	<i>the leaf</i>
daim ntawv	<i>the sheet of paper</i>
kua mis	<i>the milk</i>
kua txiv hmab	<i>the grape juice</i>
lub mis	<i>the breast</i>
lub ntaws	<i>the navel</i>
lub nyiaj	<i>the coin</i>
lub txiv	<i>the fruit</i>
phau khaub	<i>the pile of clothes</i>
phau ntawv	<i>the book</i>
phau nyiaj	<i>the stack of bank notes</i>
tsab ntawv	<i>the postal letter</i>
tsab xov	<i>the message (written)</i>
txoj hmab	<i>the vine</i>
txoj kev	<i>the road</i>
txoj kev thaj yeeb	<i>the way of peace</i>
txoj leeg	<i>the nerves</i>

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txoj ntaws	<i>the umbilical cord</i>
zaj xov	<i>the message (spoken)</i>